

Kara Deskin

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Summary

Backend Software Engineer building scalable systems and applied ML solutions in Python and Go, with a focus on APIs and distributed data.

Education

University of Kansas (KU) Lawrence, KS
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, GPA - 3.2/4.0 May 2025
Relevant Coursework - Software Engineering II, Artificial Intelligence, Data Structures and Algorithms, Compiler Construction, Database Systems, Communication Networks, Computer Architecture
Certification - Machine Learning A-Z, Udemy January 2025

Skills

Backend & ML - Python, Go, SQL, REST APIs, API design, distributed systems, concurrency (Go), caching, data pipelines, pandas, NumPy

Cloud & Infrastructure - Docker, AWS, Azure, CI/CD, Linux, Git

Web & Visualization - Flask, Streamlit, React, TypeScript, HTML, CSS

Projects

Reframe - AI Mental Health Chatbot May 2025 - Present

GitHub - github.com/karadeskin/reframe

- Built and deployed an ML-backed chatbot using Streamlit for journaling and mood tracking
- Implemented sentiment analysis with SQL-based logging to support trend analysis and data visualization

Music Recommendation System (PCA + KNN) September 2024 - Present

GitHub - github.com/karadeskin/Music-Recommendation

- Built a content-based music recommender using Python, SQL, and Spotify feature data
- Applied PCA and KNN for dimensionality reduction and similarity scoring, exposed via a Flask API

Work Experience

Acellus Kansas City, MO
Full-Stack Developer Apprentice August 2025 – Present

- Owned backend development while collaborating with product and operations stakeholders for the Acellus Gold Store e-commerce platform using Go, ScyllaDB, and REST APIs, supporting student purchases, admin workflows, and order management
- Designed and maintained backend services with attention to scalability, consistency, and fault tolerance in a distributed database environment
- Architected multi-layer caching and optimized ScyllaDB schemas and partition keys, significantly improving API performance and reducing database load
- Debugged production issues (race conditions, caching invalidation, distributed database issues) and wrote unit tests to improve reliability and maintainability

KU Wingspan - Center for Learning and Writing Support Lawrence, KS
Programming, Calculus, and Chemistry Tutor August 2022 - May 2024

- Tutored over 30 students in Python, Calculus, and Chemistry, improving problem-solving and coding efficiency
- Developed personalized learning plans, resulting in a 20% improvement in students' test scores
- Delivered technical explanations and live problem-solving sessions to diverse learners, translating complex concepts into practical outcomes

Leadership

WeCode KC - Web Dev and Programming Volunteer February 2024 - Present

- Provided IT support and web development guidance to 20+ high school students learning HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
- Designed and reviewed student web projects for responsiveness and user experience
- Created a welcoming space that encouraged creativity through web design